

THE STONE AGE: PALAEOLITHIC & MESOLITHIC

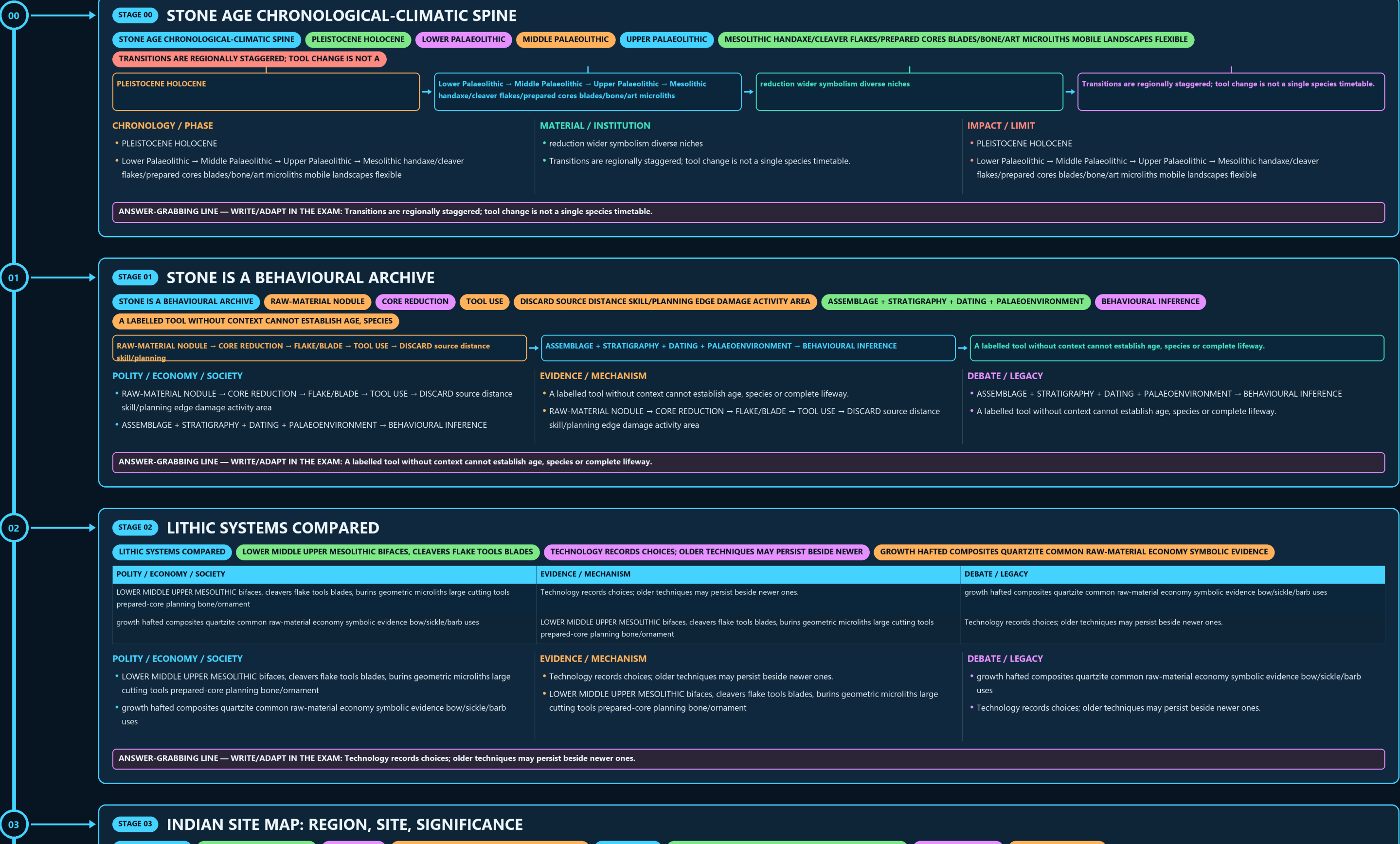
STONE AGE CHRONOLOGICAL-CLIMATIC SPINE → STONE IS A BEHAVIOURAL → LITHIC SYSTEMS COMPARED → INDIAN SITE MAP: REGION → MOBILITY-SUBSISTENCE-SOCIAL LOOP → ROCK ART AND SYMBOLIC

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g11 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



- Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.

STAGE 03 INDIAN SITE MAP: REGION, SITE, SIGNIFICANCE

MESOLITHIC EVIDENCE

→ Adamgarh → Mesolithic evidence

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SOUTH: Attirampakkam → early Acheulian and Middle Palaeolithic chronology
- DECCAN: Hunsgi-Baichbal → quarry, factory and landscape organisation

STAGE 04 MOBILITY-SUBSISTENCE-SOCIAL LOOP

REPEATED OCCUPATION AND STORAGE MAY INCREASE WITHOUT FULL FARMING

→ Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Repeated occupation and storage may increase without full farming or permanent villages.
- Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

STAGE 05 ROCK ART AND SYMBOLIC LIFE: INFERENCE LADDER

HUNTING, DANCE, GROUP ACTION, ANIMALS AND CHANGING STYLE UNCERTAIN

ART EXPANDS BEHAVIOURAL EVIDENCE BUT IS NOT ILLUSTRATED SCRIPTURE.

HISTORICAL RESULT

- dance, group action, animals and changing style uncertain: exact myth, deity, artist identity or direct ritual meaning
- VERDICT: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.

STAGE 06 MESOLITHIC TRANSITION: ADAPTATION, NOT REVOLUTION

UNEVEN PATHWAYS TOWARD NEOLITHIC PRODUCTION

DEBATE / LEGACY

06

STAGE 06

MESOLITHIC TRANSITION: ADAPTATION, NOT REVOLUTION

MESOLITHIC TRANSITION

ADAPTATION, NOT REVOLUTION

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches +

UNEVEN PATHWAYS TOWARD NEOLITHIC PRODUCTION

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal

selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps
- selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps
- selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

DEBATE / LEGACY

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps
- selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production.

07

STAGE 07

LIMITS AND CURRENT RESEARCH

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SPARSE FOSSILS + DISTURBED SITES + BROAD TOOL LABELS

FALSE SHORTCUTS

ONE TOOL

ONE PEOPLE

DATE CONTEXTS, RECONSTRUCT REDUCTION SEQUENCE, COMPARE REGIONS, STATE CONFIDENCE

REFINED CHRONOMETRY AND LANDSCAPE STUDY CAN REVISE EARLY DATES.

INDIAN PREHISTORY IS A MOSAIC OF LONG CONTINUITY AND

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PROBLEM: sparse fossils + disturbed sites + broad tool labels + uncertain associations
- FALSE SHORTCUTS: one tool = one people
- innovation = migration

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- burial = hierarchy
- RESPONSE: date contexts, reconstruct reduction sequence, compare regions, state confidence
- Refined chronometry and landscape study can revise early dates.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

08

STAGE 08

STONE AGE ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

STONE AGE ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10 MARKS

DEFINE PHASE

DIAGNOSTIC TECHNOLOGY

TWO SITES

15 MARKS

LITHIC COMPARISON

SYMBOLIC EVIDENCE

10 MARKS: define phase → diagnostic technology → two sites → subsistence → caution

15 MARKS: chronology → lithic comparison → ecology/mobility → symbolic evidence → limits

20 MARKS: geological frame → methods → four-stage technology → regional site map

economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict

MUST DISTINGUISH: relative/absolute date; artefact/assemblage; microlith/sedentism.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 10 MARKS: define phase → diagnostic technology → two sites → subsistence → caution
- 15 MARKS: chronology → lithic comparison → ecology/mobility → symbolic evidence → limits

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 20 MARKS: geological frame → methods → four-stage technology → regional site map
- economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict

DEBATE / LEGACY

- MUST DISTINGUISH: relative/absolute date; artefact/assemblage; microlith/sedentism.
- CLOSE: technology records adaptive choices, not a uniform evolutionary ladder.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

6. CURRENT LINK

7. MAINS ANGLES

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles

LEGACY / NUANCE

- She discusses Lower, Middle and Upper Palaeolithic sites separately, including tool types and manufacturing contexts.
- Isampur is treated as a centre of stone-tool manufacture.
- Middle Palaeolithic discussions include Attirampakkam and the Levallois technique.
- Mesolithic levels can yield animal bones and pottery; some claims of domesticated cattle, sheep, goat, dog and pig are questioned.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.